Hark The Herald Angels Sing, Glory To The Newborn King

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Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Double Trouble (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
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Hark The Herald Angels Sing, Glory To The Newborn King

by commander_lioness, TheStarGayzingEtherian

Summary

After Netossa and Spinnerella have to pull out at the last minute in taking part in Angella's Nativity play at the local community centre, Catra and Adora are dragged in to be the replacement Mary and Josephine. The couple haven't had the best relationship with religion in their lives… but maybe making a few kids and families happy will more than make up for that. (Catradora, Modern AU, Fluff)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

They shouldn’t have been doing this tonight. Catra had plans for some last-minute Christmas shopping and Adora already had an appointment with a good book. But well, the universe did love to throw a wrench into the works of the happy couple’s lives. But this wasn’t the worst either young woman had been through.

Catra sat quietly as she saw the snow trickle down outside as their car made its way down the small country road. Being a felid, she wasn’t the biggest fan of cold weather. She hated how the snow got into her fur and would much rather be snuggled up under a blanket with Adora, purring softly as she got some well-deserved pets on her head and scritches behind her ears.

Adora just kept her eyes on the road, trying to make sure they didn’t crash. The snow was coming down pretty hard and she was shocked that the roads in general hadn’t been closed completely. Her brother Adam had been telling her just earlier that day about how he and Teela had been snowed in back in her hometown of Eternos.

As she turned around the next corner, checking the Sat-nav in front of her, she glanced at Catra, still pouting about the fact they had been dragged out to take part in this. Both of them had been aware they’d been chosen to be backups in case something went wrong, but they hadn’t figured they’d be actually called up like this.

“Sure it’s not too late to tell Glimmer I came down with a cold or something?” Catra asked a little bitterly.

“Considering we talked to her over the voice call just this morning and you didn’t sound even the slightest bit nasally,” Adora stated. “No, I don’t think so.”

“Eh, at least I tried,” Catra snarked, her usual tactic of deflecting her issues with a dark sense of humour. “Do you know why Netossa and Spinnerella had to back out exactly?”

“Well as far as I can tell from what Glimmer said, they took Frosta out with her new sledge this morning since well, how often does it snow around here?” Adora explained. “But well Frosta hit a rock or a tree or something and broke her arm and they had to take her to the hospital.”

“Ouch,” Catra admitted. “Yeah, I can definitely sympathise.” She sighed. “But I still feel uncomfortable about doing this whole thing.”

“I know, and to be honest, I’m not sure how I feel too, but we did promise Glimmer and Angella and well… you and I know a thing or two about promises.”

“Yeah, yeah,” Catra sighed. “How far away are we?”

“Should be just about… here,” Adora then said, as their little hatchback turned the corner into the parking lot.

Tonight the local Brightmoon Community Centre was putting on a nativity performance for families and their children. Angella, the mother of Adora and Catra’s friend Glimmer who ran the centre, always took great pride in running the event every single year. For the past few years, the role of Mary and Josephine had been played by Netossa and Spinnerella and Adora and Catra had figured that it’d be the same this year.

But no, the happy couple couldn’t make it that night due to their daughter’s injury so now Catra and Adora had to play the part. And if the couple were honest, they were still feeling conflicted about the whole thing. They… hadn’t had the best relationship with Christianity and religion in general to put things mildly.

The two of them had grown up in the care of a woman named Weaver, an abusive woman who loved to use religion and her devotion to god as a way of justifying her treatment of her two wards. She would call the two of them sinners for the fact that both of them were gay and that Catra was trans, call Catra slurs and saying people like her weren’t in God's design. She would also

drag both of them to her abusive church where the preachers would often read sermons claiming queer people and people of colour were lesser than them and deserved to rot in hell.

Suffice to say, Adora and Catra were glad to have gotten out of that abusive place when they'd gotten the chance. And in the over fifteen years since then, their lives had gotten better. Catra had transitioned, Adora had met her twin brother and his wife and she and Catra had tied the knot.

But despite their happiness, the memories and trauma of their upbringing would often resurface. A childhood like the one they'd both had was one no one expected them to ever fully recover from, even though both Catra and Adora were pushing thirty by that point. But even so, the two had tried to avoid most discussions of religion wherever possible.

Heck, the two had explicitly avoided a church wedding when they'd gotten married. But now, both of them knew they couldn't pull out of starring in the nativity play. They knew how much this meant to Angella and Glimmer.

As they got out of the car and Adora grabbed the pet carrier from the trunk, the two wives walked towards the front door, both of them feeling a little nervous about the play. Neither of them were actresses, hell, Adora's terrible acting skills were an inside joke between her and Catra.

"So… we're doing this, right?" Catra said.

"Looks that way," Adora admitted. "You know, if you really don't want to, we could ask Glimmer if there's someone who doesn't mind playing a double role and taking the place of Joseph. I don't think Sea Hawk would mind."

"No, I can do this," Catra insisted. "It's just… I can't help but think of Weaver laughing like the smug bitch she was at me for doing this. That by doing this I'm finally opening up to God or something. I don't care about God, I don't care about religious

crap and as far as I'm concerned, all it's done is hurt people, especially folks like us."

"I can understand that… but Weaver's been dead for years, Catra… and well, I don't see her ghost haunting us right now."

"I know… but I'm not wrong for feeling this way am I?"

"No, of course not," Adora reassured her wife, kissing her on the cheek. "I'd be lying if I didn't feel the same way. So I'm giving you the chance to back out now if you're still really not okay with this."

"No, no, I'm fine with it," Catra reminded her. "Angella's like the mom we never got and I don't want this to go badly for her. And also, since this is Mary and Josephine instead of Mary and Joseph, I bet that's gonna piss Weaver off wherever she is. Her stupid book never did say anything about the holy couple being lesbians… and definitely nothing about Joseph being a trans girl."

"That's the spirit!" Adora cheered.

And at that moment, the two of them heard a voice calling to them from down the nearby hallway. "Adora, Catra, so good of you to make it!"

The two of them saw Angella and Glimmer, running towards them. When she arrived, Angella wrapped the two wives up in her arms and wings, hugging them as tightly as she could. Catra loved Angella's hugs, how warm they felt, that this woman truly did love her and Adora as if they were her own.

"We're not late, are we?" Catra wondered.

"Oh no, you're not," Angella reassured her. "We've still got a couple of hours to go. Everyone's still getting ready."

"Did you bring the baby Jesus with you?" Glimmer asked.

"Mhm!" Adora chirped. "Just let me get him out for you."

She placed the pet carrier on the floor and made a cooing sound as she opened the door. “C’mon Swifty! Here boy!”

A little yap was heard from the carrier as a tiny, golden retriever puppy jumped out and scampered along the floor. Swifty, short for Swift Wind after a video game character Adora had made when she was younger, washers and Catra’s adorable puppy. And Adora figured his cuteness would make him a good stand-in for the baby Jesus.

“Wow, he’s an excitable one isn’t he,” Angella remarked.

“Don’t worry, the little guy tires himself out easily,” Catra told her. “He’ll be fast asleep by the time the play starts.”

Adora just went ‘awww’ at the sight of her tiny pet and scooped him up into her arms, gently nuzzling her nose against Swifty’s own. Catra just smiled fondly at how adorable her wife was with her puppy. Nothing warmed her heart more than knowing this was the woman she was spending the rest of her life with.

“Well, we’d better get the pair of you down to the dressing rooms, everyone’s already there and waiting. I’m going to go and see how Casta and Micah are doing with the stage,” Angella stated, flying down the hallway with her wings. Glimmer pouted a little, slightly annoyed that her hybrid genetics had only given her tiny little wings on her back that would barely be capable of making her fly.

“So uh, who's playing who?” Adora asked as she and Catra followed Glimmer to the dressing room.

“Oh we have *quite* the ensemble cast,” Glimmer insisted as she opened the dressing room door. Inside, Adora and Catra could see the room in question, one of the rooms usually used for one of the therapy groups that was held at the centre that had been done up into a makeshift dressing room that looked like the ones used at the big theatres in the city.

Bow suddenly turned around in his chair, currently having his fake beard applied. “Oh hi Adora, Catra!”

“Hi, Bow!” Adora chirped, waving to Glimmer’s husband. “Who are you playing?”

“I’m playing the shepherd,” Bow explained. “Though to be honest, I’m not sure why I need a beard exactly.”

“Well I think it looks handsome on you, Bow,” Perfuma insisted, just finishing up Bow’s costume. “And you’re going to look great in your costumes too, girls!”

“I think I’m honestly going to be one of the rare occasions where the role in a nativity play is played by someone of actual middle eastern descent,” Catra remarked. “Are you playing anyone, Perfuma?”

“Oh yes, Scorpia, Entrapta and I are the three wise women!”

“Entrapta and you, I can see being wise… but Scorpia?” Catra had to joke. “She’s never exactly been the sharpest tool in the shed.”

Scorpia then poked her head from around the corner, the Scorpioni woman already in her costume, the brown robes barely covering her muscular form and arachnid parts. Clearly it was a bit too small for her, but she didn’t seem to mind. “Hey, I may not be big in the brain department, but who's the one who finally helped you get the courage to pop the question to your lovely wife there, wildcat?”

Catra blushed, her ears drooping in embarrassment. “Well… fair point there, Scorp.”

Adora giggled.

At that moment, another head poked its way around the corner, a tall black man with red eyes and short dyed navy blue hair. From the expression on his face, he didn’t exactly look fond of being

here. “Can someone help me with my lines? I’m not exactly fond of this dialogue.”

“Hordak?” Catra asked. “What are you doing here?”

“Oh Entrapta asked Hordak to be King Herod this year,” Bow stated. “Usually it’s Micah, but he’s got a bit of a sore throat tonight.”

“Truthfully, I’m not a fan of villainous roles,” Hordak remarked. “As a student of the theatre, I much prefer a variety of possible performances. But as an actor, I feel obligated to do my best for this.”

“Entrapta also promised to buy him dinner,” Bow stated.

“Hang on, Big H,” DT then chimed in, having just been with Mermista and Sea Hawk looking over their lines as the innkeeper and his wife. “Let me take a look at that script for you. If there’s anything wrong with it, I’d know it. I did write it after all.”

“Yes, and it’s clear you wrote the part for someone else in mind,” Hordak argued. “If I am to be playing such a nefarious character, I feel it should be more suitably dynamic, not with dialogue written for a children’s cartoon.”

“You *are* performing for children, sweetheart,” DT reminded him. “But fine , fine, you don’t want to play Saturday morning cartoon villain? Fine, how about we channel someone else for your performance? Perhaps your best Tim Curry impression? Or how about Patrick Stewart? I know you’ve got quite the Shakespearean vibe to you.”

Hordak sighed. “Fine, I can accept that, but at least let me ad-lib some dialogue so I can make my performance sound a bit more authentic.”

“Deal, but don’t go too off-script!” DT agreed, before the lizard person handed a pair of scripts to Catra and Adora. “Speaking of

the script, you'd better brush up on your lines, girls. Not that long until curtain."

"Surprised you're *not* playing a part yourself, DT," Catra stated. "With your shapeshifting powers, you'd be able to play practically everyone in the whole damn thing."

"Alas, that would be within my ability," DT explained. "But it would not be fair of me to deny our friends the chance of taking to the stage."

"Fair point," Catra accepted. "Well, I'd better go rehearse. Coming, babe?"

"Sure!" Adora chirped. "But Perfuma, can you take care of Swifty for a bit?"

"No problem!" Perfuma agreed. "I can handle that little one."

Swifty yapped adorably as he was then scooped up in Perfuma's arms, before the tanned woman took him aside. Then Catra and Adora went to the other side of the room to rehearse their lines, Catra smiling as she walked with Adora, seeing her friends around her. Perhaps this wasn't going to be so bad after all.

"Okay, people let's get moving!" DT then called out. "Not long until curtain!"

A couple of hours later and it was about time for the performance to begin. In the Community centre's large theatre, a large stage had been erected and a large gathering of families and their children had arrived, all of them sat in the audience and waiting patiently for the performance to begin.

Catra was already in her costume and looking out through a hole in the curtain. She wouldn't lie, there was a lot of people out there and it made her a little anxious… but then again, more people had come to hers and Adora's wedding and she'd made it through that more or less okay.

“Well, it’s not exactly Broadway, but that’s quite a crowd,” Catra replied.

“Well this is a big event,” Adora replied.

Glimmer then approached the two of them and Catra had to laugh. Glimmer was playing the role of the angel Gabriel, well, Gabrielle in this version. She was wearing a costume that honestly made her look more like a sparkling fairy than an angel, something that was just making Catra smirk.

“Oh wow, oh woooow,” Catra remarked smugly. “This just made my night. Hey there, Sparkles… huh, that name actually kinda fits for once.”

“Hah, hah, very funny Catra,” Glimmer groaned.

“And who are you supposed to be? The tooth fairy?”

“I’m an angel!” Glimmer growled. “And I knew you’d fucking laugh. As if this damn outfit being too damn tight wasn’t the worst of my problems.”

“Look on the bright side, Sparkles, at least you have a pair of decent wings now,” Catra chimed in.

“I hate you.”

“No you don’t, and besides, you’re cheering me up right now, so count that as a good thing.”

“Adora. Help. Please.”

“Oh no, my wife has been down in the dumps all evening, so I’ll take any smile on her face I can get.”

“Gah, you traitor.”

“Do you have a magic wand with that outfit too?” Catra then chimed in again.

“No, but if I did I’d use it to make your tail go straight up your-”

“Alright, ladies!” Angella then interrupted, cutting her daughter off. “Time for the show to begin!”

Catra just looked at Glimmer with a knowing smirk before Glimmer then rolled her eyes. Catra hadn’t heard the last of this.

Suddenly the music outside began to play, courtesy of Castaspella and her music and lighting rig. A rendition of Jingle Bells of all things. It wasn’t exactly biblically appropriate, but Catra didn’t care. Anything that tarnished the good Christian memory of the nativity story was good in her book.

As the crowd led into applause, Angella walked out on stage, acting as the narrator for the performance.

“Thank you, thank you,” she said. “Welcome everyone to our little play. So glad you could come, even with the dreadful weather we’ve been having here lately. Tonight, I’m here to tell you a little story, a story of the first Christmas the world has ever known. It begins many years in a little town called Nazareth where we see a loving couple named Mary and Josephine living their happy lives… until they are paid a visit by an unexpected visitor…”

Adora took a deep breath, smiling reassuringly at Catra, before she then walked out onto the stage. The little kids at the front got very excited and Adora gave them a little wave. Angella grinned with pride at Adora, before she continued her narration

“Now Mary was a bright young woman and very devoted to god. She didn’t have much, but her faith was what kept her going.” Angella then turned. “One day, something unexpected happened, when an angel of the lord appeared before her.”

As Angella waited for the angel to appear, there was an audible grunt as Glimmer awkwardly pushed through the curtains. Her wings had gotten caught in the fabric and Catra was barely stifling her laugh backstage.

Glimmer quickly regained her composure and looked over at Adora, who pretended to jump in surprise.

“Oh my goodness!” Adora exclaimed.

DT facepalmed from behind the curtain. That definitely was not in the script.

“Do not fear, Mary of Nazareth!” Glimmer said, doing a voice that sounded like a slightly bad impression of her mother. “I am Gabrielle, a messenger of the lord. I am here to tell you that you will give birth to a baby who will be the Son of God. You shall call him Jesus and he will be the King of Kings.”

“King of kings?”

“Yes, he is destined to do a lot of great things. Be honoured that you have been chosen by the lord to bear his child.”

With that, Glimmer pushed back through the curtain and shot Catra a glare. This time, the feline could not help herself and everyone heard her laugh. Angella quickly drowned out the noise with her narration.

“While Mary was scared, she trusted in God and agreed to do as he asked. Now, Mary was betrothed to a carpenter named Josephine.”

Catra did her best to wipe the grin off her face. She grabbed the walking stick that served as her staff and walked elegantly through the curtains. The kids got even more excited when she appeared and Catra tried not to blush from the attention. She wasn’t used to people applauding her so much.

Angella smiled with pride again, this time for Catra, before she carried on.

“When she realised Mary was going to have a baby, Josephine was very confused.” Catra rolled her eyes and turned to Adora, giving her the most comically exaggerated pout she could

manage. Not only did the kids and some of the parents start giggling, but Adora nearly burst out laughing as well. Catra's pouting was too cute and a very welcome distraction.

Angella, clearly enjoying how much the audience was loving this, kept going with her narration.

"But then the angel appeared before Josephine as well-"

"Boo!" Glimmer yelled as she jumped through the curtains.

Catra screamed and fell over backwards into Adora's muscular arms. The room roared with laughter at the hilarious role reversal and Glimmer's successful revenge on Catra. The feline, now scowling furiously at Glimmer, looked up at her wife to try and gauge her reaction.

She was happy to discover that Adora had finally given in and was laughing louder than anyone else. When Catra saw that, she smiled. Good old Sparkles - this was exactly what was needed to relieve the tension.

The pinkette then wiped a tear from her eye from all the laughing, calming down long enough to say her lines.

"Don't be afraid, Josephine! God himself is the father of Mary's baby and you and her shall be blessed with a son who will change the world!"

With that, Glimmer, still chuckling to herself, bowed in triumph and returned backstage. Everyone clapped, including Angella, who had found what had happened particularly amusing. She quickly cleared her throat and continued.

"While Josephine was even more confused by all this, she eventually accepted that Mary was to bear the lord's own child and very soon, the two of them were married."

Catra stood back up and made a big show of brushing herself down before getting on one knee in front of Adora and kissing her

hand. Adora was very surprised – they were only supposed to hug in the script.

But Catra had decided that, if Angella wanted her to do a grand romantic gesture, she would go all out and give Adora what she deserved. Also, the feline was so happy to see Adora finally enjoying herself and wanted to make the moment last longer. Adora certainly did enjoy it and the audience cooed at the romance while Angella kept going.

"Now, around the same time, the Roman Emperor had ordered that everyone had to go back to the place they were born so they could be counted. This meant that Mary and Josephine had to travel many miles to another small village called Bethlehem."

Catra stood back up and, not letting go of Adora's hand, led her in a circle around the stage. As they passed by the curtain, DT slipped a pillow into Adora's free hand that the blonde immediately stuffed up her shirt to make it seem like she was pregnant. Despite her best efforts, Catra failed to hide what was happening and the kids began to laugh once more.

The feline would normally have been annoyed. After all, it was not as if they had had much rehearsal or any incentive to do this besides goodwill towards Glimmer and her mother However, Catra found herself smiling at the children. She was happy they were having fun and if she were honest… she was having fun too.

"Once they got there," Angella spoke again. "Mary was very close to having her baby and unfortunately, the local inn was completely full."

Catra jumped as she was pulled from her thoughts by Sea Hawk and Mermista suddenly pushing through the curtain with a flourish. There was a small applause when they did; Sea Hawk was something of a local celebrity. Mermista then spoke in her usual unenthusiastic tone.

"Yeah, the inn's super full or whatever," she rambled on, seemingly rather uninterested in her lines. "You can't come in, sorry."

Sea Hawk then practically leapt forward, reciting his line with impressive enunciation. "Oh but fear not my good friends! I have a lovely stable filled with hay and friendly animals who would be happy to share with you!"

With that, the two went back through the curtain, followed by another small applause from the audience. Then there was an awkward pause as Catra and Adora headed over to the corner of the stage where the manger had been set up for them. As they awkwardly knelt down behind it, Angella spoke again.

"That night, the baby was born. Mary and Josephine wrapped him in swaddling clothes and placed him in the manger."

DT rushed to the side of the stage carrying the now sleeping Swifty, very visibly passing him to Adora. A more conservative audience would have been horrified. Instead, they all collectively sighed over the ball of cuteness that the blonde now put in the little basket. She then took a deep breath and said her final line of the night, followed by Catra's.

"We shall call him Jesus."

"As the lord intended," Catra winked at her wife, who smiled lovingly back at her.

Swifty, who was clearly very comfortable in the basket, rolled over happily while snoring adorably. As the curtains opened yet again to reveal Bow, Adora discreetly pulled the pillow out from under her shirt and put it on the stage for her and Catra to kneel on. They were going to be there a while. Meanwhile, Bow smiled and waved at the audience, getting all the kids very excited.

Angella grinned and continued. "Now, in the hills surrounding Bethlehem, some shepherds, or rather, a single shepherd was watching over his sheep." Bow reached behind his back and

dramatically revealed a large soft toy sheep while making very loud sheep noises. There was yet more laughter from the audience.

Catra rolled her eyes at that, but Adora giggled too.

"Suddenly, the angel that had appeared to Mary and Josephine appeared to him also".

Glimmer slipped through the curtains with relative ease this time. Bow turned to face her, gasped as if he had seen a ghost, and pretended to cower behind his sheep. This was enough to make the whole room laugh. Bow truly was born for this role. Glimmer could not help but smile lovingly as she said:

"Don't be afraid! I have good news for you! This very day, in Bethlehem, Jesus Christ has been born. You'll find him wrapped in swaddling clothes and lying in a manger." Glimmer then made her way backstage, blowing her boyfriend a cheeky kiss as she did so. Bow blushed and forgot what he was doing next.

Angella face-palmed herself and reminded him, trying not to break character.

"The shepherd was amazed by this news and immediately ran down the hill to find the baby." Regaining his composure, Bow stood back up, put his soft toy sheep over his shoulders, and purposefully walked over to where Catra and Adora were. They were both grinning from ear to ear. Angella continued:

"Once he found him, he knelt before him and told Mary and Josephine what the angel had said." With that, Bow knelt down next to them and pretended to speak to them. Catra raised her eyebrow in amusement while Adora nodded along to the fictitious conversation. The curtains then began to move as Scorpia, Entrapta and Perfuma squeezed through.

"Now, far away there were three wise women. That night, they saw a star in the sky and figured out that something special must have happened". Scorpia then stepped forward and pointed up at

the star decoration that had been hanging over the stage the whole time:

"Oh wow! A new star! This is so exciting!" Entrapta then moved forward and, to no one's surprise, she ad-libbed her line. "Despite there being several valid scientific reasons for this phenomenon, in this historical time period it makes perfect sense to immediately attribute it to a random Jewish prophecy. So let's go to Israel!"

Perfuma practically rushed forward in an attempt to save the situation which already had several of the adults chortling.

"Um, yes. Let us follow the star to Israel where we may find the… uh… King of Kings." Perfuma, Scorpia and Entrapta then followed each other around the stage as Angella continued her narration:

"The three wise women set off and followed the star all the way to Israel's capital city: Jerusalem. There they went to see the king: King Herod." The moment his name was spoken, King Herod materialized in such a dramatic flourish that the room collectively gasped. Hordak not only had a fake beard, but he wore a grand purple toga along with a reasonably impressive plastic crown. He motioned to the three women, declaring:

"Welcome, great women of infinite wisdom. Why dost thou seek an audience with me?" If Perfuma could have face-palmed herself, she would have. Scorpia slowly moved forward to respond:

"Um… there's a cool new star in the sky and we followed it here. Anything cool happen recently?" Poor Scorpia had fumbled her line, presumably distracted by Hordak's Shakespearean King Herod. As if that was not bad enough, Entrapta then went completely off-script after Hordak ad-libbed again:

"No. Nothing cool hath occurred here for a long time. Begone already, I already tire of thy presence.

"A-ha! He made a joke! Ha ha! Cause Israel's in the Middle East and it's hot over there and uh…" Scorpia blushed awkwardly, Perfuma once again running forward to salvage the situation.

"Okay! Um… there's a prophecy that says a star will shine when the King of Kings is born in Israel. Please, Your Majesty, direct us so we may see him." With that, Hordak turned away in disgust, dramatically twirling his toga as he did so:

"I know not where this child is. However, if the scriptures are to be believed, he will likely be found in or around that ghastly little peasants' hamlet to the north of here: Bethlehem. And if you do find him, bring him to me. I am the one true king around here and I shall not allow any child to be more powerful than I!"

Just as Entrapta was about to say something else, Perfuma cut her off, clamping a hand over her mouth. "Thank you! You have been most helpful!"

With that, she practically dragged Entrapta over to where Catra, Adora and Bow were still kneeling; followed closely by Scorpia.

Angella rolled her eyes, glad that things hadn't gotten too out of hand. She once more carried on with the narration.

"So, the three wise women went to Bethlehem and soon found the baby. When they did, they knelt before him and gave him three lovely gifts, which would be considered the first Christmas presents."

The three women knelt down next to the other three, and produced their three stylishly wrapped presents. They gave them to Catra and Adora, who accepted them with happy smiles. As each of the three women handed out the present, they all stated what the gift was.

"This is gold, because you know, the kid deserves to have something nice and hey it might be worth something," Scorpia said, trying her best to stick to her dialogue more or less.

"And this is frankincense," Perfuma stated. "Because the king deserves to smell like a true divine monarch."

“And this is a Nintendo Switch!” Entrapta chirped. “Because who the hell knows what Myrrh is and honestly, the kid will have a lot more fun with this!”

DT groaned backstage. “Oh actual Jesus, give me strength.”

Adora and Catra though, did have to laugh. Was this in the script? Probably not, was this fun though? Absolutely yes.

And so the play eventually came to an end. As Catra and Adora took their bow with the rest of the crowd erupting into applause, Catra in particular had to find herself smiling from ear to wear and not just because Glimmer had been forced to wear such a ridiculous costume. No, she was smiling because it was clear the children in the audience were cheering for her.

She’d clearly made a lot of kids happy that night and to Catra, well, if she could bring some light into a child’s life, maybe this was all worth it. After all, it’s not like her own childhood had been a happy one. As she and Adora walked off stage and back into the dressing room, Catra stretched her arms and tail, mewling sleepily as she did so.

“Well that was fun, but I’m really tired now,” Catra admitted. “I never thought acting could be so exhausting.”

“Trust me darling, it can deftinetly be exhausting,” DT remarked. “But it is so very worth it. And you both were marvellous! You should consider a career in the theatre.”

“Eh, I’ll think about it. I’m surprised the dork I’m married to didn’t fumble up her lines.”

Adora blushed. “Well… I did want to make a good example in front of the kids.”

“Well, I say you both are leading lady material!”

Perfuma then walked over to Adora, carrying Swifty who was still fast asleep. “Oh, Adora, you’ll be wanting to take Swifty home?”

“Yeah, he was the most precious little baby in a manger wasn’t he?”

“Oh yes! And I’m still surprised he slept for the whole thing.”

“What can I say,” Catra remarked. “I told you the pup tires himself out easily. Seriously, he spends like half the day either chasing Melog or his own damn tail.”

Perfuma giggled a little, and Adora placed Swifty back in his carrier before she and Catra then headed off to get changed back into their regular clothes. A while later, the two of them were heading back out of the community centre to their car, Glimmer, Bow and Angella having come to see them off.

“Thank you again for doing this for us, you two,” Angella said gratefully. “I don’t think one of my nativity plays has gone down this well in a long time.”

“Glad we could help,” Adora replied, before Glimmer then hugged both her and Catra tightly.

“You’ll be coming around for Christmas dinner, won’t you?” Glimmer asked.

“Of course, I wouldn't miss it for the world!” Adora chirped. “But we better get home. My wife looks as though she’s about to pass out at any moment.”

“Yeah and I’d rather do it in our bed and not out here in the freezing cold,” Catra argued. “See you, Angella.”

“Take care girls!” Angella bid them farewell, as Adora and Catra got into the car.

As she sat down, Catra sighed as she thought about the play and the story it told. While she honestly still didn’t care about

Christianity and it certainly wouldn't be something she'd change her mind on anytime soon, there was something in the story that resonated with her deeply.

Mary and Joseph would have done everything for their child, even to the point of Mary giving birth in a barn. And Catra always did have that soft spot for children. It made her wonder… was it time for her and Adora to perhaps consider having children? They were still a bit young, sure, but it was something Catra was definitely considering now, more than she'd ever done.

"Hey, Adora?" Catra asked. "Question… how did you feel about playing Mary?"

"Oh, it was a lot of fun!" Adora chirped. "Honestly, I'm surprised I remembered my lines so well but… I guess there was something about the part that kinda made me feel good doing it you know?"

"Was it because… you got to be a mom?"

Adora blushed. "Maybe."

"I… I think we'd make really good moms, you know?" Catra asked, her ears twitching and tail swishing anxiously yet adorably. "Not that we don't have to have kids right now obviously!"

Then Adora chuckled a little before she looked at Catra with wide blue eyes. "Well um… about that…"

"W-What?"

Adora took a deep breath and considered her words carefully. She had been wanting to tell Catra this for a couple of days, but she just hadn't been able to figure out how to tell her. Her mind had been distracted and she and Catra had both been very busy with the leadup to Christmas.

And yet, there seemed to be no better moment than right now to finally tell her.

“Okay sooo…” Adora began. “I hadn’t been feeling well for a few days and I looked up what the symptoms were. And then I took a test from the doctors and…” She began to tear up, the realisation finally hitting her. “Catra… we’re going to have a baby!”

Catra’s eyes lit up and she began to tear up too. She then hugged Adora tightly, both wives embracing one another as tight as they could. Words couldn’t describe how Catra felt at that moment. A mix of joy, anxiety, surprise, it was certainly an eclectic mix of emotions, that was to be sure.

“Oh Adora… that’s wonderful,” Catra whispered.

“Consider it our little Christmas miracle,” Adora replied, still crying tears of joy.

“It’s definitely a miracle alright,” Catra agreed, as she sighed into the embrace of her wife… and the mother of her future child.

End Notes

And last but not least, a lovely little nativity story I wrote with the help of my friend Lioness! Do check out her work, she's really talented. I hope you've all had very pleasant holidays and I'll see you all hopefully for some more stories in the new year!

If you liked the fic, please be sure to comment!

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